

CAMNEMI STUDY

GKS-U TRACK GUIDE

Global Korea Scholarship (Undergraduate)

Difficulty & Recommendation

Embassy Track · University Track (UIC) · Associate Degree

Based on 2026 GKS-U Application Guidelines (NIIED)

1. Three Tracks at a Glance

Total 280 scholars · apply to ONE track only

1 EMBASSY TRACK	2 UNIV TRACK · UIC	3 UNIV TRACK · ASSOC
Quota 150 global Cambodia: 3 seats (Gen 2 + R-GKS 1)	Quota 100 global No country cap	Quota 30 global 9 junior colleges
Difficulty ★★★★★	Difficulty ★★★	Difficulty ★★
Verdict VERY HIGH	Verdict MEDIUM	Verdict LOW
Key info Up to 3 universities (≥1 Type B) Embassy screening → NIIED Deadline: Oct 17	Key info 10 universities · ONE dept Direct to university Eng/NatSci focus · Deadline: Oct 31	Key info ONE college · 2-3 yr diploma Job-ready, practical majors Deadline: Oct 31

2. Track Details & Difficulty

Why each track is hard / easy — honest assessment

Track 1 · Embassy Track — ★★★★★ Very High

Item	Detail
Quota	3 seats for Cambodia (General 2 + R-GKS 1) out of 150 globally
Competition	Hundreds of Cambodian applicants → ~1% acceptance
Universities	Up to 3 (General/Overseas Koreans) · 2 Type-B only (R-GKS)
Screening	Embassy document review → NIIED final selection
Apply when	GPA 80%+ / top 20% · TOPIK 3+ or IELTS 6.0+ (10% bonus) · strong essays
Strategy	1 top Type A + 2 Type B (e.g. Korea Univ + JBNU + Keimyung/Pusan)

Track 2 · University Track (UIC Bachelor's) — ★★★ Medium

Item	Detail
Quota	100 globally — no country cap → realistic odds for Cambodia
Universities	10: Ajou, Daegu, Dong-A, Inje, Keimyung, Konyang, Kookmin, KOREATECH, Sungshin, Yeungnam
Apply	ONE university + ONE department (direct to university)
Focus	Engineering & natural science (industry-cooperation curriculum)
Language	No TOPIK to apply · 1-year funded Korean → TOPIK 3 → degree (Korean 100%)
Apply when	GPA ~70-80% · any language level (Korean program covers it)

Item	Detail
Best picks	Inje (4 UIC depts) · Ajou (Software) · Kookmin (SW/AI) · Konyang (AI/Security)

Track 3 · University Track (Associate Degree) — ★★ ■■■ Low

Item	Detail
Quota	30 globally · 9 junior colleges · least known → fewest applicants
Apply	ONE college, ONE department (direct)
Duration	2-3 years, practical & job-ready diploma
Language	TOPIK 3 after 1-year Korean program · same funded structure
Apply when	Lower GPA · wants beauty/practical/media majors · fastest D-2 path
Best picks	Gumi (Medical Beauty) · Hosan/Osan (Beauty Smart Care) · Vision College (Beauty Health)

3. Recommendation Matrix (Cambodian Student)

Match the student profile to the right track

Student profile	Best track	Why
TOPIK 5+ / IELTS 6.5+ · GPA 85%+	Embassy General	Only route to top brands (SNU, Korea Univ, Yonsei)
GPA 80% · TOPIK 3 / IELTS 5.5	UIC Bachelor's	No country cap, direct university, realistic odds
No score · wants engineering/CS	UIC — Inje/Kookmin/Ajou	Funded language year → TOPIK 3 → degree
No score · wants beauty/practical	Associate Degree	Easiest entry, job-ready 2-yr diploma
Low GPA · no score · urgent	Associate + self-fund backup	Guaranteed D-2 path

You can apply to **ONLY ONE track**. If rejected from Embassy Track, you can re-apply to the same year. GKS is a lottery — **always prepare a backup** (university own) before betting everything on GKS.

■ Source: 2026 GKS-U Application Guidelines (NIIED) & University Information files. Quotas and universities may change in the 2027 guide (expected mid-September 2026). Confirm with the university's GKS office before applying.